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THE EL PASO TIMES, Thursday, February 13, 1975

Hitting Still Bothers Cohen

Hitting continues to worry University of Texas at El Paso baseball coach Andy Cohen.

"That's still our weak point although we've been average at hitting the ball lately," commented Cohen as he prepares his squad for the season opener at 1 p.m. Friday at Dudley Field against Texas Tech's Red

Raiders. "We're starting to hit the ball fairly well and that's what we're going to need to balance our ball club."

The Miner defense and pitching seems to be the farthest thing from the mentor's mind, especially since he has a host of infielders and hurlers returning from last year's 27-24

squad.

But, once again Cohen has denied to inform anyone as to who his starting pitcher will be in the opener or nightcap against the Raiders. "I'm not going to make up my mind until Friday as to who will start. Pitchers Roy Stringer and George Landreth are coming

around pretty good as is Don Modlinski. They're all rearing to go.

Art Bravo looks like the top candidate for second base after wagering a full-scale battle with Allan Morris for the position. "But don't forget Morris," warned Cohen. "You can't sell Morris short. He's as good as Bravo and may see a lot of action in the second game. It's a good problem to have, having two kids with great talents battling for one position."

Although Tech finished low in the Southwest Conference standings last year, Cohen compares the Raiders with powerhouses Arizona and Arizona State. "Tech has all around balance, just like Arizona and ASU," said Cohen. "You can't sell Texas Tech short."

One member of Tech's squad that Cohen wishes he had nabbed is Noah Castle, a utility infielder who has hit more homeruns out of Dudley Field during his high school days at Burges than any other area player.

The Miners also host Tech at 1 p.m. Saturday for another doubleheader.

McFarland Figured Wrong

MINNEAPOLIS (AP) — St. Louis Cardinals tight end Jim McFarland said Wednesday he thought he was all set to be sent to Kansas City as a free agent, but was told the Cards wanted too much, a second round draft choice.

That's the reason given him by Chiefs Coach Hank Stram two years ago, after he'd played an option year without a contract, McFarland testified in U.S. District Court.

McFarland said he tried to

get a \$20,000 bonus on top of a \$27,000 salary offer from the Cardinals because he figured that's what a second-round draft choice was worth.

But he said he got nowhere.

McFarland was the fifth present or former player to testify in the suit by 16 plaintiffs who seek to overturn the National Football League's Rozelle rule. The rule, named after NFL Commissioner Pete Rozelle, gives the commissioner the right to set

compensation when teams can't agree after a free agent is signed.

McFarland played out his option in 1972 and again in 1974. He becomes a free agent May 1.

McFarland was called to buttress the NFL Players Associations' complaint that free agents are restricted by the Rozelle rule in trying to deal with other clubs, since the team doesn't know whom the commissioner will take in exchange.

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